Where ONE Stands

An honest account of what is built, what is missing and where the money comes from — graded with **the product's own readiness bands**, because a system that refuses to give students a false score should not give itself one either.

182	33	77	11	9	0
LIVE API ROUTES	DATABASE MIGRATIONS	TEST SUITES	ROLE PORTALS	QUESTION FORMATS	WAYS TO TAKE PAYMENT

01 What ONE is, in one paragraph

ONE is a shared workspace that takes a person from "I am in college" to "I have a job," and lets the college and the employer stand in the same room while it happens. Today those three parties live in three separate worlds — a student with a CV on a laptop, a placement officer with a spreadsheet, an employer with a pile of identical PDFs. ONE puts them on one screen.

The idea that distinguishes it is a refusal. Every competitor sells a *score* — "you are 74% job-ready." ONE gives a **band** instead. Overall readiness runs Not Enough Evidence, Developing, Progressing, Ready For Next Step; each individual topic is graded on the same ladder, topping out at Demonstrated — which is the vocabulary this document borrows to grade the product itself. It always shows the specific records that produced the band, it can be rebuilt from those records at any time, and below four pieces of evidence it declines to guess. An employer never sees it. That restraint is enforced by the database, not by policy — and it is the reason students and colleges will put honest data in, which is what makes everything else worth anything.

02 Build state, by capability

- DEMONSTRATED — real, enforced, end to end
- PROGRESSING — works, with a named limit
- DEVELOPING — partly there, honestly labelled
- NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE — structure exists, substance does not

Readiness engine

DEMONSTRATED

Evidence in, bands out, with the factor list and the model version stored alongside every snapshot. Recomputable. Refuses to produce a number.

Academic records & verification

DEMONSTRATED

A student declares, the issuing institution verifies, and verification is permanent — a database trigger refuses to reverse it. Only the issuing institution can decide.

Assessment engine

DEMONSTRATED

Governed question bank with review states, blueprint-assembled papers from approved questions only, per-student shuffled papers frozen at start, answer keys never leaving the server, submit-once scoring.

Student profile & documents

DEMONSTRATED

Real file upload, virus-scanned, encrypted per file. If the scanner is unavailable the file is refused rather than stored unchecked.

Institution administration

DEMONSTRATED

Academic structure, roster, CSV import with preview before commit, staff invitations, scoped reporting with cohorts under five suppressed.

Privacy & data rights

DEMONSTRATED

Export everything, request deletion, grant and withdraw consent, legal holds that stop an automatic deletion erasing evidence under investigation.

Hiring pipeline

PROGRESSING

Post, target, apply, shortlist, screen, schedule, score, offer, accept. Employers build their own screening tests; rejected candidates hear why. Still no connection to the applicant-tracking systems large companies already run.

Platform operations

PROGRESSING

Kill switch per feature, per organisation and per person, every flip stamped with a reason. Trust-and-safety cases, audit log, queue repair. Screens are bare but real.

Security posture

PROGRESSING

Server-side authorization on every request, cross-tenant access impossible by database structure rather than by permission check, backups encrypted to a key the server does not hold. One unauthenticated route now exists, deliberately and narrowly, for the public profile (ADR-031). Staff two-factor decided but not switched on. No independent penetration test.

Mobile app

PROGRESSING

Student journey properly built; staff and employer dashboards working. Exams are deliberately laptop-only and the app says so.

Public profile

DEMONSTRATED

A student can publish a page anyone with the link can open, choose what it shows, and switch it off for everyone at once. Only a fingerprint of the link is stored, so the database holds no working URLs.

Calendar

PROGRESSING

Interviews, exam windows, assigned tasks and roadmap deadlines gathered into one view per person, with an export for Outlook and Google Calendar. A live subscribable feed is still a download.

Staff role depth

DEVELOPING

Counsellors, analysts and department heads can read their data; several of their actions are not yet wired. The pages say so plainly rather than showing dead buttons.

Learning content

NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE

The factory and the authoring desk are both built now — taxonomy, versioning, draft→review→publish, and screens to write and approve. The stock is not: a thin technology-oriented seed and nobody yet writing into it.

AI

● NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE

Orchestration built and provider-neutral; the help assistant is grounded in a curated corpus so it cannot invent features. No model connected — held on cloud access. One adapter remains.

Billing

● NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE

Nothing. No plans, subscriptions, entitlements, payment provider or invoices. Deliberately deferred on 6 September; the trigger to start is a paying customer with a date.

> **How to read this table.** These bands are an **assessment**, not a measurement — the same distinction the internal commercial model insists on between actual and assumed figures. The counts above the table are measured from the codebase. The bands are judgement, and should be challenged.

03 What is missing, in the order I would fix it

Ranked by what unblocks the most value soonest, not by size. Four items that stood here on 13 September have since shipped — candidate feedback, the calendar, employer screening assessments and the public profile — and two more have shrunk to the half that was genuinely missing. What is left is mostly not software.

01 Nobody can pay us

Still the only major area with zero implementation, and it still hides because it has no screens. Manual invoicing works for a handful of pilot colleges and fails at the fiftieth, and fails completely for a student who wants to pay directly.

ALREADY THERE	MISSING
Role and membership gating, which billing can build on without displacing a placeholder.	Plans, subscriptions, entitlements, payment provider, invoices, tax handling.

02 No front door for anyone not already at a college

Half of this is now fixed. A graduate *can* ask their old college to confirm a record, and the college has a queue that distinguishes a current student from a former one from somebody it holds no record of at all.

What remains is the door itself: there is still **no self-signup**, so a person whose institution never joined has no way to create an account. Building ONE's side of that is straightforward; the registration step is identity configuration and waits on cloud access.

SHIPPED SINCE	MISSING
Institution directory, retroactive verification requests, the college-facing queue.	Self-registration, and an independent-learner account for people with no institution.

03 No content library beyond a thin technology seed

The existential one, and the one least changed. There is now a desk to write, review and publish from — with approval and publication requiring two different people — so the obstacle is no longer software.

It is stock and reviewers. A model can draft; it cannot carry authority. Depth in three fields beats shallowness across thirty, because a student can tell the difference within ten minutes.

SHIPPED SINCE	MISSING
The authoring and review screens, and the routes that serve published content to the five student pages.	Written material, and a named subject expert per field to approve it.

04 No interview or speaking practice

Nothing yet observes a student answering a question. A student never trained on speaking is disadvantaged by default, so this is not optional — and it has to come from model observation, because a coach in every practice session does not scale past one campus.

Three commitments already settled: the **microphone is checked first and is a gate, not a penalty** — poor audio yields "we could not assess this," never a low band; the output is a band with categories, never a number; and the target is *being understood*, not sounding foreign. Practice stays private from employers, permanently.

BUILDABLE NOW	WAITING ON
The session record, the privacy constraints, and the microphone gate — none of which need a model.	Cloud access, for the part that listens.

05 Staff two-factor is decided but not on, and nobody external has attacked this

The decision is recorded and the application already handles the prompt; it needs a separate staff sign-in pool, which needs cloud access. Until then the strongest control on a placement officer's account is a password — today's weakest link.

And every security claim in the companion document is *our own assessment of our own work*. Before real student data arrives at scale, somebody outside should be paid to attack it — with more to look at now that one unauthenticated route exists.

06 Nothing connects to the systems large employers already run

An employer can now post, screen, interview, score and offer entirely inside ONE, which is enough for a mid-size company. A large one already has an applicant-tracking system, and will ask what this replaces rather than what it adds.

The calendar has the same shape of gap: it exports, but does not yet subscribe, so an interview added today does not appear in somebody's Outlook tomorrow without a re-import.

04 Where the revenue comes from

No prices are set and none should be quoted yet. What follows is the shape, ordered by how soon each becomes real.

Colleges, per student per year

WORKS TODAY — MANUALLY

The beachhead. Colleges already hold placement budgets and already pay aptitude-test vendors and training firms; we consolidate several line items rather than creating one. The buyer is judged on a single number we can move and prove.

Friction: slow procurement, tied to the academic year, often needing management sign-off.

Employers, by subscription

WHERE THE MARGIN IS

Access to a verified pool plus the hiring tools. Subscription, not per-hire — per-hire rewards the customer for hiding the outcome and turns the relationship into policing.

Blocker: no employer assessments, no calendar, no ATS connection. A large company will ask what this replaces.

Students and alumni, freemium

AFTER THE FRONT DOOR EXISTS

Largest audience, hardest money. Free learning, profile and applications; paid for what is genuinely scarce — a verified shareable profile, speaking and interview practice, priority access. Small price, large volume.

Verification as a service

THE UNDERRATED ONE

Background verification is already an industry that confirms degrees by chasing a registrar for weeks. We would hold that record, confirmed by the college itself and permanent. It also earns from people who never use the rest of the product — and it gives colleges a reason to join that has nothing to do with current students.

The cost that scales is AI. Every practice session, generated lesson and assistant conversation costs money per use. Per-feature spend caps are already built into the platform — that instinct was right, and it means cost per student must be understood before AI features go wide. **The cost that does not scale is content review:** a subject expert is a fixed cost per field, not per student, so margin improves with scale. Every number in a commercial conversation should be labelled measured or assumed.

05 Two things worth refusing to sell

The readiness band, to employers

It is the most obviously monetisable thing we own, and an employer would pay for "show me everyone rated Demonstrated." Sell it and students start gaming it, colleges start inflating it, and within a year the data — and the product built on it — is worthless. The restraint is the asset.

Student data, to anyone

Same logic, shorter path to the same ending, plus a regulator. If either is proposed in a meeting, the answer is not "that is unethical" — it is "that is the fastest way to destroy the thing we are selling."

06 The sequence I would follow

1. **Finish the pilot and measure the outcome.**
   Still first, and still the thing every later conversation depends on: this college's placement rate moved by this much.

2. **Open the front door properly.**
   Retroactive verification shipped; self-signup is the half still missing, and it is what lets somebody with no institution use any of this.

3. **Build billing the moment there is a paying customer with a date.**
   That is the trigger already written into the decision to defer it.

4. **Switch on staff two-factor and commission a penetration test**
   before real student data arrives at scale.

5 **Pick one field and make its content genuinely excellent.**
The desk to write it now exists; what it needs is a person who knows the field.

6 **Then speaking practice**
, once cloud access makes the part that listens possible.

> **The one-line summary, a day later and still true.** The product is close to sellable, and the ability to get paid is still not built at all. What changed is that four of the nine gaps closed in a day — because the engines behind them already existed and only the doors were missing. What is left is mostly **not software**: written material, a subject expert, an external security test, a payment decision, and cloud access. Stock, a door, and a till.

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